EDUCATION FOR RESUSCITATION
KEY MESSAGES

GUIDELINES 2025
EUROPEAN RESUSCITATION COUNCIL©

Ongoing faculty development improves teacher quality, which directly impacts learning

Educate all members of the community about cardiac arrest
Adapt educational approaches and material to the context, target group, and resources available in lower-resource settings

Frequent formative assessments guide course participants' learning in all types of life support courses

Start resuscitation training in early childhood education and then continue with annual resuscitation training in schools



Train emergency medical services dispatchers in cardiac arrest recognition and dispatcher-assisted CPR

Provide all healthcare professionals with accredited resuscitation training at the appropriate level if they treat cardiac arrest patients

Team debriefing after cardiac arrest training for healthcare professionals encourages routine clinical debriefings after real-life resuscitations

Use spaced learning (several short teaching sessions distributed over time), and in-situ learning (at the workplace) to improve skill acquisition and retention

Teach teamwork competencies and ethical principles in all basic and advanced life support simulations

Real-time chest compression feedback devices should be used in resuscitation teaching

SCAN FOR MORE HELPFUL MATERIALS

CPR - cardiopulmonary resuscitation

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- Every person can learn to save lives starting in early childhood. Support school programs that teach CPR to schoolchildren.
- The core topic of CPR teaching to lay people is proper high quality chest compressions, ventilation of the lungs and early use of an AED. This can save lives in cardiac arrest.
- Look for Basic Life Support or First aid courses that suit you and your community. There are CPR training programmes specially designed for specific populations, like families of heart patients of all ages.
- CPR training can be done everywhere and needs little resources to do so, even a teddy bear can serve as a manikin to practice chest compressions.
- Get trained as a community first responder – these are lay person volunteers alerted by mobile phone to help in life threatening situations nearby.
- Cardiac arrest can happen during sport (even in professional football, cycling, or running) – the ERC programme 'Get Trained Save Lives' (GTSL) for sports clubs is a short but highly successful programme. Get your sports clubs enrolled into GTSL and also into a public AED program.
- As cardiac arrest can happen anywhere, there is a big European initiative to improve CPR and first aid at work – attend and support these courses to make your workplace safer.
- Even for healthcare personnel cardiac arrest is a rare event. Therefore, all healthcare providers need specific resuscitation training depending on their level of interventions in emergencies.
- All ERC courses are based on modern educational methods to quickly train people to perform CPR at a high level. But skills that are not used often decay – if you are trained, make sure to keep up to date with refresher courses.
- These courses simulate cardiac arrest situations to make you familiar with the steps to save a life.
- The ERC course instructors take care of your progress in learning CPR. They have all had special training to teach CPR, which was developed and delivered by the ERC.
- Science shows that if a person in a team attended an accredited course, like the ERC courses, more patients survive. That means we have scientific evidence that CPR training improves survival after cardiac arrest.
- The ERC provides and promotes CPR courses for everyone.

SCAN TO LEARN MORE ABOUT OUR COURSES